

Prototyping with Claude Design Workshop

A how-to guide for creating your first HTML prototype using Claude Design

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TL;DR

Claude Design is Anthropic's rapid prototyping tool — live at claude.ai/design. Feed it a Design System, prompt it with an idea, get an interactive HTML prototype you can comment on, iterate, run through review, or hand off to Claude Code.

Claude Design is in Research Preview. It has started to show promise, but is still early! It'll improve as you teach it more things about your design system and use it over time.

The good so far...	Where it's less developed...
• Rapid ideation of many directions or a quick prototype • UI / UX visualizations • Big swings in a single shot • Autofilling content for you • Creating UI controls on top of whatever you're prototyping	• Super high fidelity that's a perfect match of your Design System • Always using the components you tell it to • Navigating your codebase with 100% accuracy • Multi-player mode

How we'll use this guide

Today we'll use this time to ramp-up on [Claude Design](#) by prototyping an idea from your roadmap. After building, you'll share it with your team. Follow the instructions below to get started.

Today's exercise

1. Goals

- Build a prototype
- Play around with tips, design systems, and get to know the tool
- Share what you made!

2. What Claude Design is (and isn't)

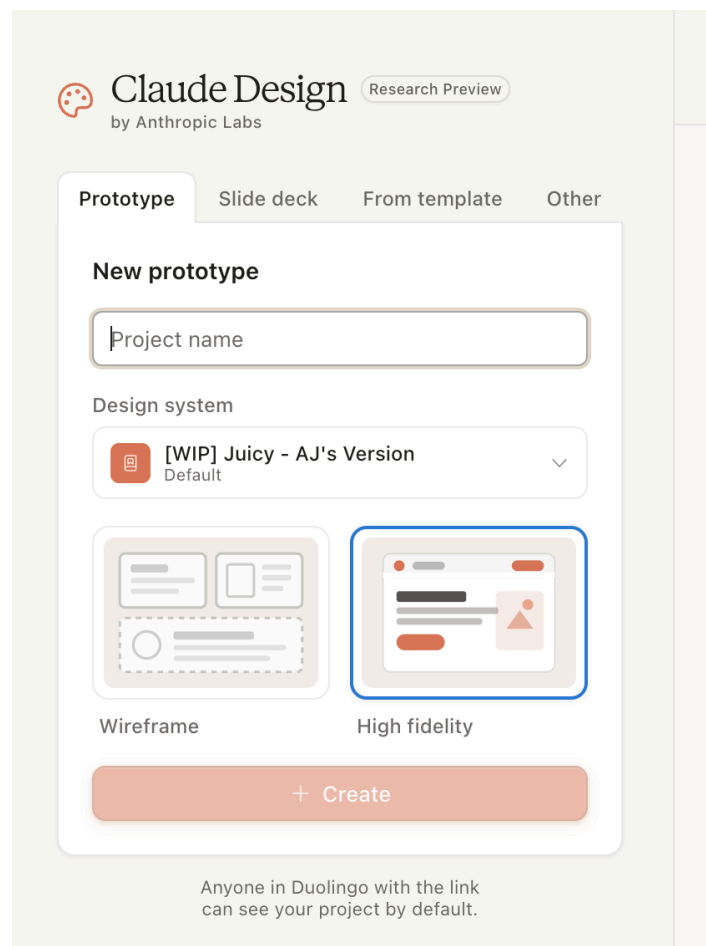
HTML-first prototyping surface. You feed it a Design System — components, Fignas, code — and prompt for prototypes, decks, or animated mocks. All outputs are plain HTML/CSS/JS/images/animations.

What makes it different

- **Editing** on the live prototype — the biggest unlock compared to Claude Code.
- **Grounded in your design system** — prototypes start from your Design Systems.
- **One-click handoff to Claude Code** as a zip with HTML + README.
- **Ask Questions toggle** — Claude clarifies before committing.

3. Get access

1. Go to claude.ai/design and sign in.
2. Select your chosen **design system** when you start a new project



4. Build something

Get to know Claude Design's capabilities by building something!

Step 0 — review the official examples

Look at the example prompts provided from [Claude Design](#)

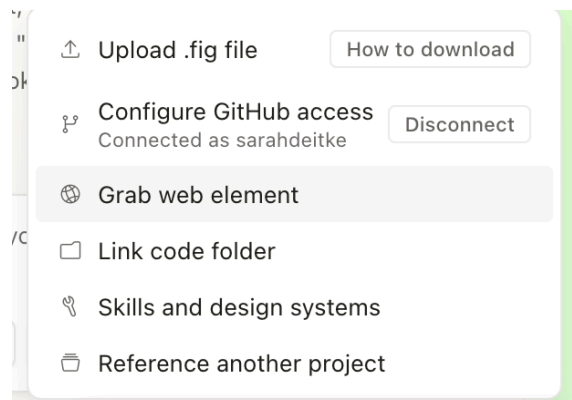
Step 1 — pick something small and opinionated from your roadmap

A copy change, a setting placement, a single new screen, or an internal-tool screen. Skip the ambitious 0→1 idea for your first session.

Step 2 — front-load context via the import menu

Bottom-left of the composer, next to Send:

- **If you want modifications to a specific screen, paste a flat screenshot or point to a specific section of iOS/Android code at the start of the session.** Don't assume the primary Design System knows every screen type or tab.
- **Add Figma Context** — Download your Figma file locally and upload them to the chat. Alt, you can copy and paste PNGs.
- **Add code** — If you have cloned code on your local computer, attach that as a file/folder to Claude Design. Anthropic claims this is the most reliable source for design context.
- **Import > Grab web element** — drag it to your browser bar, click elements on any live page, paste back into the composer. Pulls DOM + computed styles + screenshot.



- **Drag or paste other files** — images, text, HTML, PPTX, DOCX. No PDF or Google Docs — export first.

Step 3 — try a proven prompt

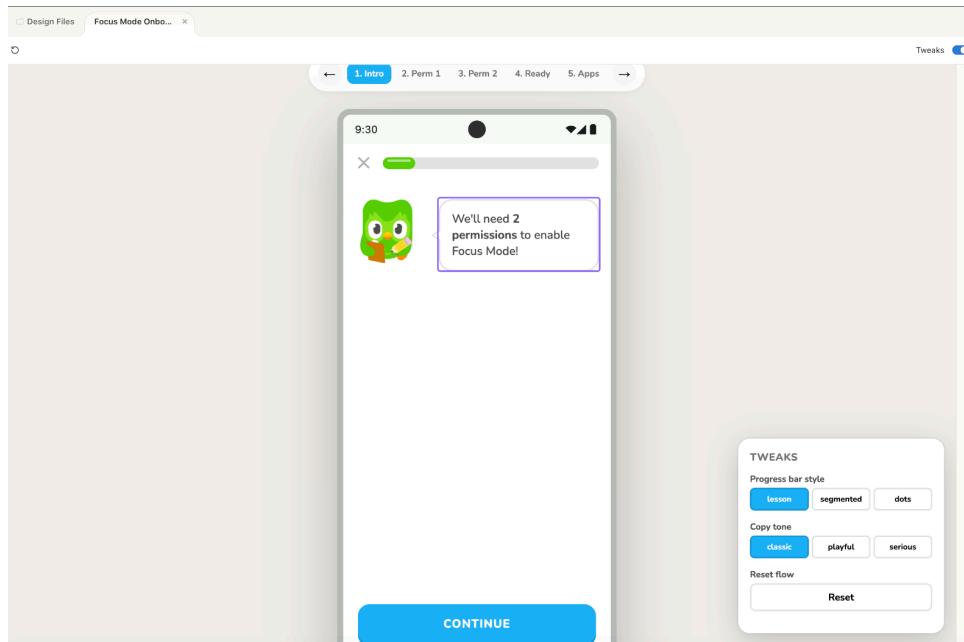
I want to add a setting for {feature}. Where should it live? Use the attached Settings section of our codebase for context, then show me 2–3 placement options.

Take {the attached Figma file} and make it interactive. Then add {insert details on changes you'd like to make}.

Turn this spec doc into a feature using our design system.

Step 4 — iterate with the preview toolbar, not re-prompts

- **Comment** — click any element, stack up several notes, send them at once.
- **Edit** — click Edit to rewrite text and align assets in place.



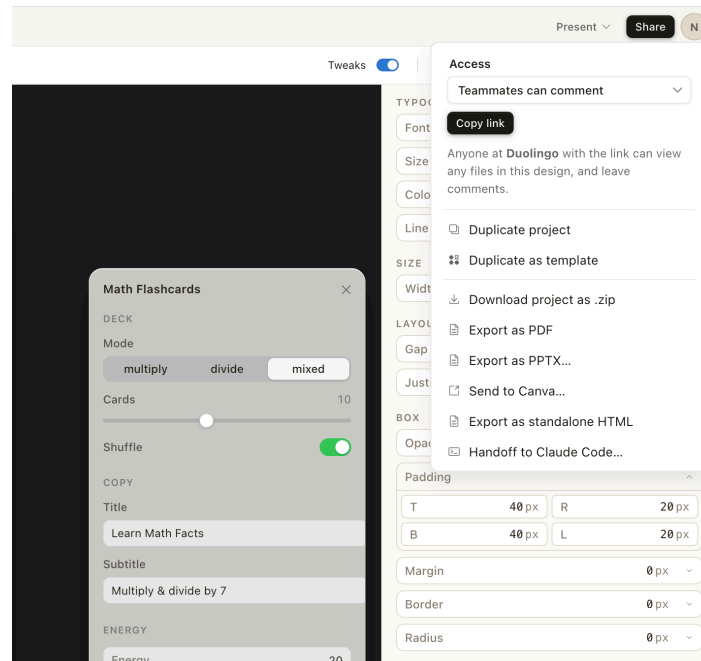
- **Knobs** — sliders for spacing, font, color. The Custom tab lets you ask for a bespoke control.

Step 5 — hand off

Export menu, top-right:

Format	Pixel-perfect	Editable	Interactive	Offline
.zip	✓	✓ (source)	✓	✓
Standalone HTML	✓	✓ (source)	✓	✓
PDF	✓	—	—	✓
PPTX (screenshots)	✓	—	—	✓
PPTX (editable)	Best effort	✓	—	✓
Send to Figma	✓	✓ (layers)	—	—
Handoff to Claude Code	✓	✓ (source)	✓	✓

Most simple: Just link to your project in Claude Design and teammates can see it.



- Click “Share” and “Copy link” - this allows your teammates to comment

BOSS MODE: Handoff to Claude Code

Claude Design is built for speed — ideation, live editing, and getting a clickable prototype in front of people fast. But a prototype is a starting point, not a finished product. At some point you'll want to turn it into something more durable: real code in your repo, wired to a real backend, version-controlled, and ready for engineers to extend.

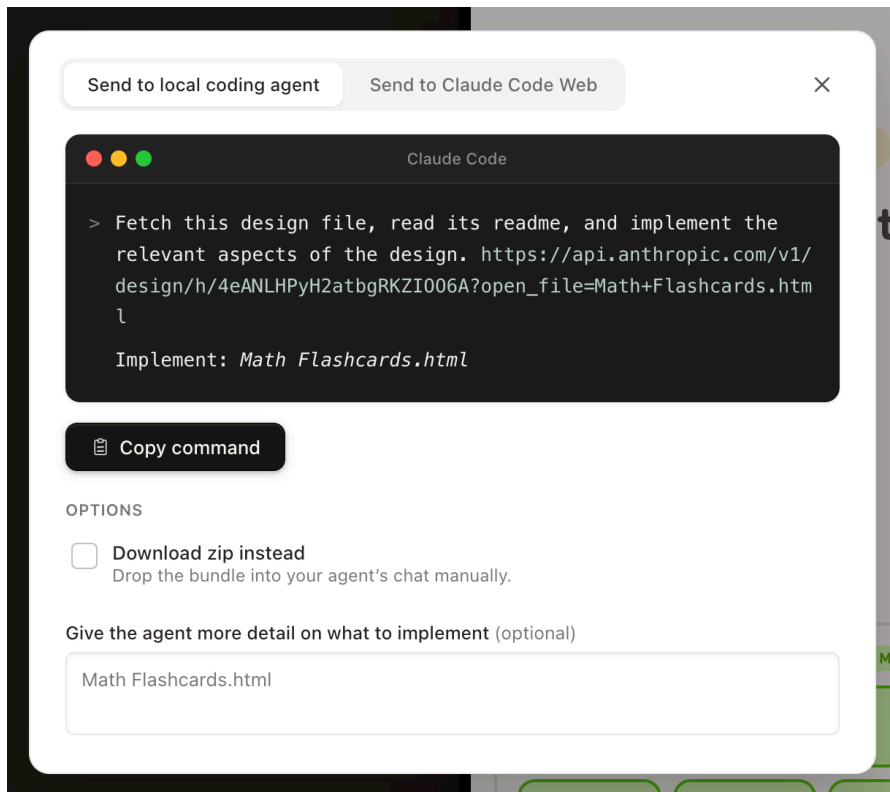
Handing your prototype off to Claude Code let's you:

- **Keep building** past what the prototyping surface supports
- **Connect to real data and backends** instead of mocked-up content
- **Get more control** over the architecture and implementation
- **Give your engineers a running start** — they inherit working code, not just a screenshot

How to do it

The handoff bundles everything Claude Code needs to pick up where you left off: the prototype's HTML/CSS/JS, the assets, and a README describing what you built. Two easy paths:

1. **Direct handoff** — From the Export menu (top-right), choose *Handoff to Claude Code*. It packages the spec, assets, and notes together in one go.



2. **Download and open** — Click *Share* → *Download project as .zip*, unzip it, and open the folder in Claude Code.

One thing to know: the handoff is one-way. You can move from Claude Design into Claude Code, but you can't round-trip back. So do your fast visual iteration in Claude Design first, then hand off once you're ready to go deeper.

Tips & examples

1. Real examples from <INSERT YOUR COMPANY NAME>

Example Projects

Insert great example projects designed in Claude Design

2. Tips that work

Prompting

- Attach the specific screen(s) you want to modify at the start of the session. Prompt:

None

explore the design system deeply, enumerate all components you know" before asking for output. Prevents invented patterns.

- Ask for options before committing. Prompt:

None

show me six type + color pairings first

- Use video references when appropriate — Claude can extract states and map them to code.

Iterating

- Use the preview toolbar (Comment, Edit, Knobs) for visual tweaks; use chat for architectural changes.
- Hold Space to dictate rapid-fire edits.
- Ask Claude to "save a new version" before big changes — it copies the file so you can diff or revert.
- Be deliberate about which HTML file you're editing. Claude Design tends to create new pages rather than iterate in place.

Power moves (underused)

- **"Make this tweakable."** Claude bakes sliders and pickers into the design — turns a static mock into a stakeholder-tunable demo.
- **Your prototype can call the Claude API with zero config.** Build a chatbot, summarizer, or rewriter inside the prototype — no backend.
- **Generate images, UI sounds, and voiceovers inline.** Useful for marketing, lesson, and animation prototypes.
- **Link other Claude Design projects** by URL: "use the same styling as that one."
- **Capture web element** — reverse-engineer any public site's styling into a prototype in one click.

Handoffs

- **Handoff to Claude Code** packages spec + assets + notes. Works today for internal tools and for real client code on known backends.
- **Send to Figma** pushes rendered pages as editable layers — useful when a designer takes over.
- **Mobile preview** is awkward. Workaround: open claude.ai/design on your phone.

3. Design systems and skills

A Design System is a bundle of five reusable skill types:

- **Brand** — colors, typography, logos, tone.
- **UI Kit** — pixel-perfect components for one surface (e.g., Claude iOS).
- **Element** — one saved thing: a slide layout, button style, card pattern.
- **Skill** — a saved method or prompt ("when I say deck, use this structure").
- **Template** — a full starting point for an output type.

Paved path: set up a new DS

On the homepage, click "Set up design system."

1. Authorize Figma and paste links to your key files (design tokens, components, marketing pages).
2. Point at your frontend folder so Claude learns your class names and CSS variables.
3. Upload brand-guideline PDFs, tone docs, or logo packages.

~5 min clicking + ~15 min of Claude working. Review, edit what's off, share with the org.

4. Where it struggles today

Set expectations with your team up front:

- **Design system recall is unreliable.** The default DS knows the path but loses colors and invents patterns. Workaround: upload the specific screen and prompt for component enumeration before asking for output.
- **Vectors and high-fidelity polish are weak.** Good for first-pass prototypes, not final visuals. It needs more assets in design systems.
- **No arbitrary MCPs yet** — Claude Design runs its own tool loop.
- **Claude Code → Claude Design is one-way.** You can hand off; you can't round-trip.
- **Figma MCP (in Chat) only reads public pages.** Inside Claude Design itself, use the built-in Connect Figma.
- **UX friction:** keyboard shortcuts don't match Figma, comments need a second submit in chat, mid-flow changes can reset the flow, PPTX screenshot exports drop some assets.